Rima ALSHOUFI

Creative Director & Interior Architect | Experiential & AI-Driven Design Leader

Luxury Retail & Hospitality • Experiential Architecture • AI Design Leadership

Creative Director & Interior Architect with 12+ years shaping luxury retail, hospitality, and experiential environments across the GCC. With an **MBA in Luxury Management(Sup de Luxe, Paris) and a BA in Interior Architect**, I merge **architectural precision, emotional storytelling, and emerging technologies** — using **AI-assisted design, visualization, and creative strategy tools** to craft innovative, human-centered brand experiences.

I specialize in **flagship retail concepts, bespoke interiors, experiential pop-ups, and spatial storytelling**, extending design into **campaigns, activations, and product development.**

Skilled at **leading multidisciplinary teams** of interior architects, visual merchandisers, product developers, and graphic designers, I integrate these disciplines into cohesive brand journeys that **elevate customer experience, strengthen luxury positioning, and support market expansion..**

Professional Recognition

- UAE Golden Visa Holder — Creative Category

Awarded for contributions to luxury retail design and experiential innovation.

- Sup de Luxe Paris (Founded by Cartier) — Design Jury Member

Selected to evaluate emerging global luxury talent in the digital age.

- Inside LVMH Certificate

Certified in luxury fundamentals, brand experience, and innovation.

- Collaborations with Global Luxury Destinations & Heritage Maisons

Delivered work for Galeries Lafayette, Printemps, Harvey Nichols, Bloomingdale's, Sephora, Tryano, and partnered with Christofle and Moser.

- Five-Star Hospitality Experience

Designed experiential environments for Waldorf Astoria, Sofitel, and JW Marriott.

- AI-Driven Creative Innovation

Advanced application of AI to accelerate visualization and elevate retail design concepts.

Let's Talk:

E: rimaalshoufi@gmail.com | **M**: +971 52 873 1303 | **A**: Dubai | Lausanne

Linkedin: https://www.linkedin.com/in/rima-alshoufi-46962628b/

Portfolio: https://rima-alshoufi.webflow.io/

Education, Expertise & Skills

Visionary, Strategic, Detail-Oriented, Collaborative, Brand-Driven, Emotionally Intelligent

Education:

MBA in Luxury Management– Sup de Luxe, Paris (2023–2024)
Specialized in luxury brand strategy, retail innovation, and experiential marketing.

BA in Interior Architecture – Damascus University (2009–2013)
Foundation in architectural design, spatial storytelling, and materiality.

Core Expertise:

Retail Architecture & Interior Design – Designing and delivering flagship stores, multi-site rollouts, bespoke interiors, FF&E, luxury detailing, execution supervision, and operational excellence.

Experiential Environments – Developing customer journey maps, crafting spatial storytelling, and driving immersive activations, pop-ups, and sensory engagement.

Strategic Brand Identity– Building holistic brand ecosystems across physical and digital environments, uniting spatial identity and intelligent experience design.

Creative Direction & Leadership – Leading multidisciplinary teams of interior architects, visual merchandisers, and digital designers, integrating AI collaboration tools to optimize workflows and elevate creative output.

Innovation & Intelligent Design – Integrating AI-powered ideation, visualization, and generative storytelling within the design process. Developing AR/VR and phygital retail environments that bridge emotion, architecture, and data-driven creativity.

GOLDEN VISA HOLDER CREATIVE CATEGORY

Awards & Recognition:

Franco-Syrian 48H de la Créativité – Winner (2010)

Recognized for "the Pixels Room Concept" — a visionary proposal blending architecture with digital innovation to create modular, flexible, and adaptive living spaces.

Skills & Tools:

AI & Emerging Tools
Midjourney | DALL·E | Runway | ChatGPT | Notion AI | Adobe Firefly | AI-assisted concept visualization & prompt design.

Design & Technical Tools
AutoCAD | 3Ds Max | SketchUp | Adobe Creative Suite (Photoshop, Illustrator, InDesign) | Canva | Figma | Notion

Professional Skills
Strategic Planning | Cross-Functional Collaboration | Campaign Storytelling | Visual Merchandising | Workflow Optimization | Brand Guidelines Implementation

Languages:

English – Fluent (C2) | Arabic – Native | French – Basic (A2)

Professional Experience

Creative Director | Mohamed Hilal Group, Dubai, UAE

Oct 2022 – Oct 2024

Directed the creative strategy, brand identity, and omni-channel campaign execution across luxury retail, fragrance, and F&B brands. Partnered with the CEO and senior leadership to align creative vision with business strategy, driving customer engagement, luxury positioning, and cultural relevance across GCC markets.

- Developed and evolved brand identities, narratives, and luxury positioning across physical and digital platforms.
- Directed 360° omni-channel campaigns for seasonal launches and product rollouts, integrating customer journey mapping and luxury positioning to deliver measurable sales-conversion uplift.
- Created immersive flagship environments, pop-ups, podiums, and premium VM displays, boosting customer engagement and measurable sales conversion uplift.
- Introduced AI-enhanced visualization and mood generation workflows to accelerate concept development, spatial storytelling, and campaign ideation across retail and hospitality projects.
- Built and managed a high-performing creative team (design, VM, content, production), cultivating innovation and cross-functional collaboration.
- Partnered with marketing, retail, and product teams to align all creative outputs with business strategy, commercial KPIs, and market-expansion objectives.

Key Projects & Achievements:

Rebranding: Hind Al Oud, Khaltat, Anfasic Dukhoon, Ana Restaurant, and 3rd Avenue.
Flagship Expansion: Designed and rolled out new flagship retail concepts and multi-site formats across GCC.
Fragrance Launch: Directed the Iconics Collection (Hind Al Oud) with integrated 360° campaigns, experiential activations, and events.
Prestige Collaborations: Led creative partnerships with Christofle and Moser, embedding international prestige into brand storytelling.
Cultural Presence: Positioned Hind Al Oud at Dubai Design Week and Abu Dhabi Art Week through immersive, art-driven brand experiences.
Digital Innovation: Directed the launch of the MHG Mobile App and loyalty program, integrating UX design, digital storytelling, and customer retention strategies.
Experiential Pop-Ups: Conceptualized and executed the Emovation Lab fragrance pop-up at UAE's largest mall, showcasing brand innovation and sensory engagement.

Professional Experience

Design Manager | Mohamed Hilal Group, Dubai, UAE

Oct 2018 – Oct 2022

Headed the Interior Design & Architecture Department for a multi-sector luxury portfolio, overseeing flagship retail, F&B, commercial, and residential projects. Partnered directly with the CEO to restructure workflows and elevate brand-aligned spatial and visual standards.

- Restructured the Interior Design & Architecture Department, introducing SOPs, workflows, and cross-functional alignment to improve operational excellence.
- Directed flagship retail design and multi-site rollouts, embedding luxury positioning, operational excellence, and customer journey mapping to support market expansion and strengthen brand equity.
- Developed and implemented visual merchandising guidelines, planograms, and product display standards to unify brand expression across all stores.
- Managed full design lifecycle: concept, space planning, FF&E, technical drawings, tendering, and execution.
- Supervised external contractors and site operations, ensuring quality control, compliance, and on-time delivery.
- Coordinated closely with project managers, production teams, and operators, ensuring stakeholder engagement, ROI-focused execution, and alignment with business-growth objectives.
- Oversaw the development of bespoke furniture, branded architectural features, and premium customer experience environments.

Key Projects & Achievements

- **Retail:** Hind Al Oud Boutique & Majlis (Dubai Mall), HOB Multi-Brand Store (YAS Mall), and multi-site rollouts for Hind Al Oud, Anfasic Dukhoon, Khaltat, across GCC.
- **Commercial:** MHG Head Office (2,600 sqm, Sharjah), Emovation Lab (Sharjah Research & Innovation Park).
- **Hospitality & F&B:** Ana Restaurant & Terrace (Dubai Mall), Milas Restaurant (Dalma Mall).
- **Residential:** Private luxury villas in Dubai, RAK and Sharjah.
- **Visual Merchandising:** Premium window displays, podiums, and pop-ups supporting GCC brand activations.

Professional Experience

Senior Designer | CWAP (Media Glass / Umuma Magazine), Dubai, UAE

Oct 2013 – Mar 2014

Worked across spatial design, editorial design, and branding for clients and in-house publications. Delivered 3D retail activations, exhibition concepts, and brand-identity assets to support experiential marketing campaigns and spatial storytelling.

- Designed and rendered 3D concepts for exhibition stands, retail activations, and promotional environments.
- Produced visual branding, logos, editorial layouts, and marketing collateral for digital and print platforms.
- Contributed creative direction for interior features, magazine spreads, and promotional graphics, ensuring brand consistency.

Event Designer | Meraas Holding (Duvent), Dubai, UAE

Aug 2013 – Oct 2013

Conceptualized and executed experiential marketing environments and event-storytelling concepts for exhibitions, corporate activations, and entertainment productions. Collaborated with project managers and agencies to deliver immersive, on-brand experiences on time and within budget.

- Designed 3D spatial layouts, stage concepts, mood boards, and event branding assets in line with client briefs.
- Coordinated with external agencies, contractors, and senior event leads for stakeholder alignment and execution excellence.
- Delivered projects ahead of schedule while ensuring premium production quality.

Key Projects & Achievements
Cirque du Soleil – Michael Jackson Immortal Tour (Dubai WTC).
Sofitel Hotel Opening Event – The Palm, Dubai.
Shah Rukh Khan Concert – Dubai WTC.
Cityscape Exhibition (Dubai).
Heritage Village Exhibition – Dubai WTC.